



Talanoa Staff Guide

tah-lah-NOH-ah · Tongan for *talking together*

A picture board that speaks. A resident taps a picture and the tablet says the words out loud.



Scan to open Talanoa

<https://tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa/>

For staff and families at Faleofaz

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1 What Talanoa is

Talanoa helps a person who can't speak tell you what they want, how they feel, and who they want to see.

It works like a set of talking picture cards on a tablet. Every picture says a short sentence out loud in a natural voice, for example the cookie picture says *"I want a*

snack." The words also appear in big letters at the top, so you can read them from across the room.

There are 12 pages with 140 pictures in total, plus six important buttons that are always on screen.

Three promises the app keeps

- **It never stays silent.**

If a voice recording can't play, the tablet's own voice says it instead.

- **The top row never moves.**

Yes, No, More, All done, Help and Stop are always in the same place, so they can be found without looking.

- **It works without internet**

once it has been set up.

2 Setting up a tablet

You only do this once per tablet. It takes about two minutes and needs Wi-Fi.

1

Open Google Chrome

Use Chrome, not a preview from email or Google Drive.

2

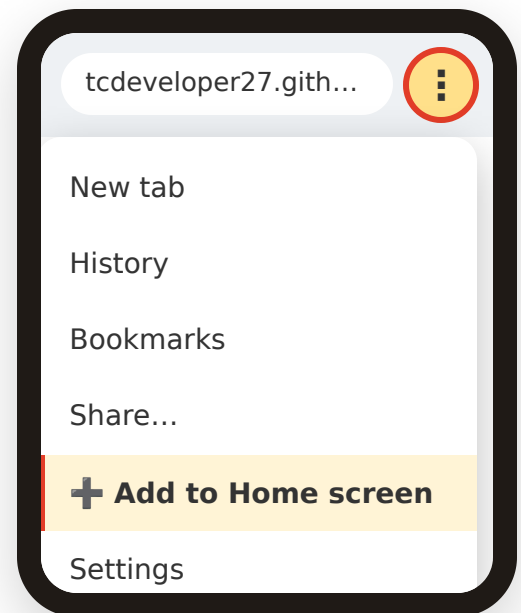
Go to the Talanoa address

Scan the QR code on the front of this guide with the tablet camera, or type **tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa** (capital T in Talanoa).

3

Tap the  menu (three dots, top right)

Choose **Add to Home screen** or **Install app**, then confirm.



Step 3 (illustration). The menu on your tablet may look a little different.

4

Open Talanoa from its new icon

It opens full screen like any other app.

5

Leave it on Wi-Fi for a minute

It saves the pictures and voice onto the tablet. Check in Settings: Status should say ✓ **Ready to use with no internet.**



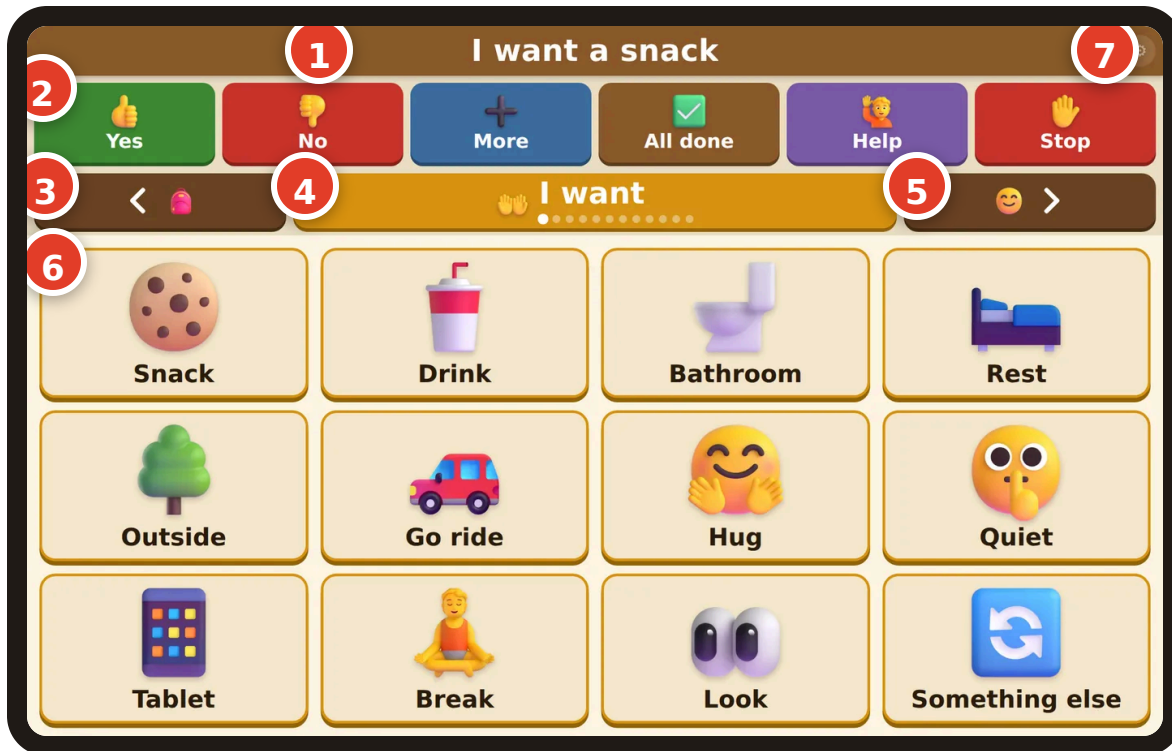
Step 4 (illustration). The Talanoa icon on the home screen.

Tip

Turn the tablet's media volume up with the side buttons, and set the screen to stay on longer (see section 12).

3 The screen at a glance

This is exactly what residents see. The numbers match the list below.



1 Spoken words. Shows what was just said, in big letters, so staff can read it too. It flashes green on every tap.

2 The six "always" buttons. On every page, never moving:



3 Back arrow ◀. Goes to the previous page. The small picture shows which page it goes to.

4 Page name. Shows which page you're on; the dots show where you are in the pages. **Tap it to see all pages at once.**

5 Next arrow ▶. Goes to the next page. After the last page it goes back to the first.

6 Picture tiles. 12 per page, always in the same spots. Tap one to speak.

7 Settings ⚙️. For staff only. It opens only when you **press and hold it for one second**, so residents won't open it by accident.

Turn the tablet any way you like

It works both sideways and upright; the tiles stay in the same order.

4 Talking with it

Tap a picture once and the tablet says the words.



One tap = one sentence

No double-tapping or holding needed.



Tap again to repeat

It starts again from the beginning.



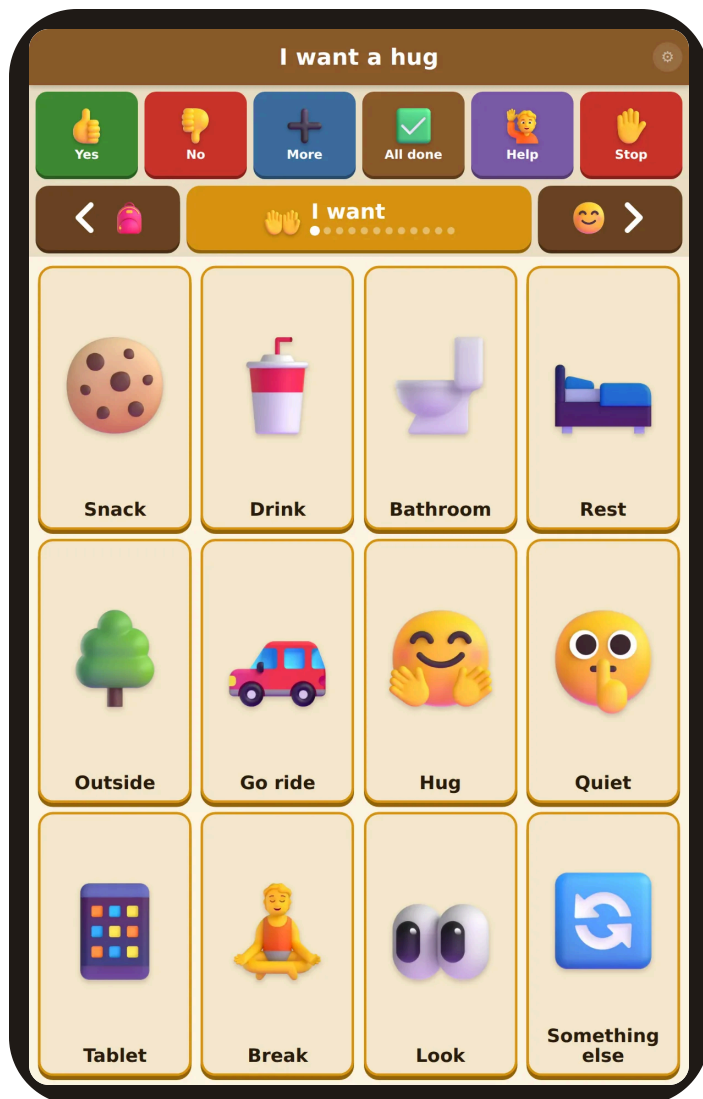
Quick taps are fine

A new tap stops the last sentence and says the new one. Nothing gets stuck.



A little buzz

The tablet vibrates slightly on each tap, if it can.

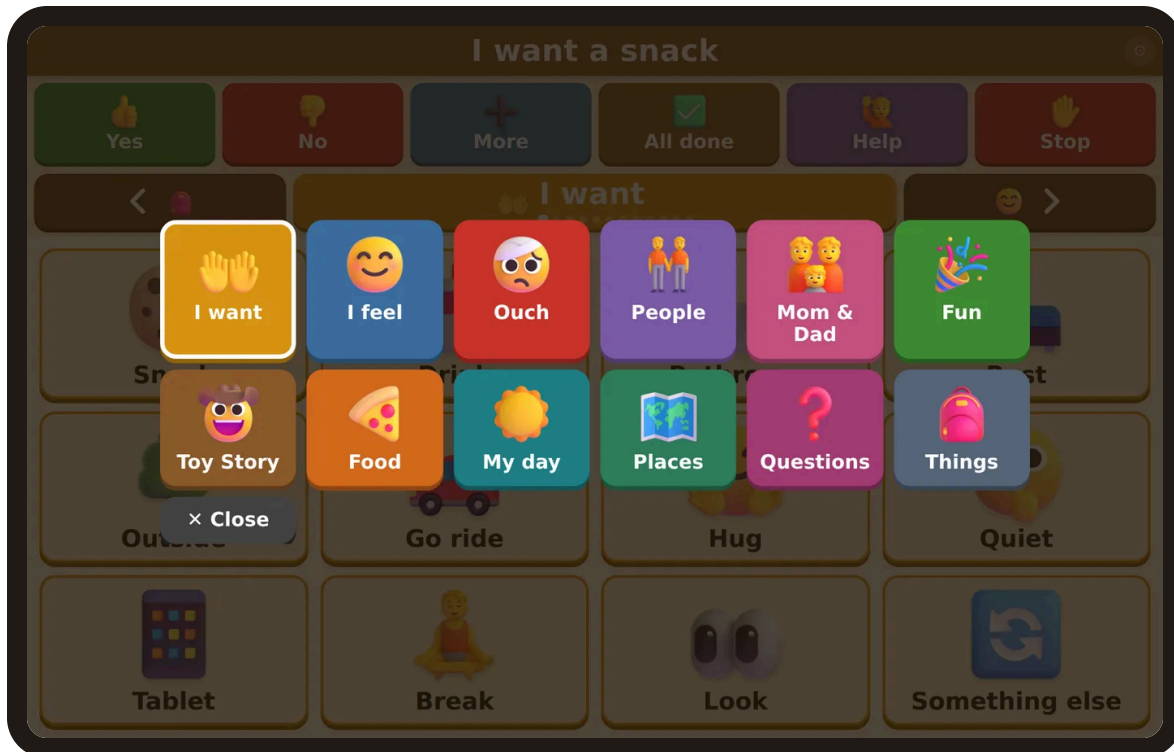


Upright, after tapping **Hug**. The top says "I want a hug".

5 Moving between pages

Use the big ◀▶ arrows to flip through the pages, like turning the pages of a book.

To jump straight to a page, **tap the page name** in the middle. All pages appear as big buttons: tap one to go there, or tap × **Close**.



Tapping the page name shows every page.

The 12 pages, in order

 I want 1 12 tiles: Snack, Drink, Bathroom, Rest...	 I feel 2 12 tiles: Happy, Excited, Sad, Frustrated...	 Ouch 3 12 tiles: Head, Tummy, Throw up, Tooth...
 People 4 10 tiles: Family, Staff, Friend, Hi...	 Mom & Dad 5 12 tiles: Dad, Call Dad, Dad's house, Dad coming?...	 Fun 6 12 tiles: Toy Story, Cartoons, Movie, Costume...


Toy Story
7

12 tiles: Howdy, Bullseye, Infinity, Sky...


Food
8

12 tiles: Hungry, Water, Juice, Milk...


My day
9

12 tiles: Wake up, Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner...


Places
10

11 tiles: Home, My room, Store, Park...


Questions
11

11 tiles: What now?, What's next?, Where to?, Who?...


Things
12

12 tiles: Headphones, Hat, Jacket, Sunglasses...

Can I call my mom, please?

Yes No More All done Help Stop

Ouch

Head	Tummy	Throw up	Tooth
Ear	Eyes	Arm	Leg
Foot	Band-aid	Medicine	Doctor

Ouch: point to where it hurts.

Can I call my mom, please?

Yes No More All done Help Stop

Questions

What now?	What's next?	Where to?	Who?
How long?	What's for dinner?	What's that?	Where is it?
Why?	Can I have it?	Don't know	

Questions: what's next, where, who, how long.

Pages can be hidden

If a resident doesn't need a page, it can be turned off for that tablet in Settings.

6 The Mom & Dad page

All the parent and grandparent tiles are together on one page.



Every Dad tile has the matching Mom tile **directly underneath it**: Dad and Mom, Call Dad and Call Mom, Dad's house and Mom's house, Dad coming? and Mom coming? The bottom row has Grandma, Grandpa, Nana and Papa.

This layout is deliberate

The family asked that Mom always appears under Dad. The app is built so this can't be changed by accident.

When a resident taps "Call Dad" or "Call Mom"

Treat it as a real request: tell them what will happen ("Let's call Mom after lunch") so they know they were heard.

7 Settings

Settings belong to each tablet. Changing them on one tablet doesn't change the others.



Press and hold the ⚙ in the top-right corner
Keep your finger on it for 1 second, then let go

Settings

For caregivers: hold the ⚙ for 1 second to open.

Voice

☒ **Michael** calm man A

☐ **Fenrir** deeper man

☐ **Heart** warm woman

☐ **Bella** bright young woman

☐ **Sarah** friendly woman

☐ **George** British man

☐ **Emma** British woman

☐ **Tablet voice** the voice built into this device

Tablet voice (also used as a backup)

Automatic: best available ▼

Speed: 1.00 B

Volume: 1.0 C

A

Voice. Tap a name to choose it. You'll hear "Hi! This is my voice." Choose the one that suits the resident.

B

Speed. Slide left for slower speech, right for faster. 1.00 is normal.

C

Volume. The app's own loudness. Also check the tablet's side buttons.

The 7 voices

Voice	Sounds like
Michael default	calm man
Fenrir	deeper man
Heart	warm woman
Bella	bright young woman
Sarah	friendly woman
George	British man
Emma	British woman
Tablet voice	the voice built into the tablet (sound depends on the tablet)

Pages to show

☒ 🍌 I want
 ☒ 😊 I feel
 ☒ 😬 Ouch

☒ 👤 People
 ☒ 👨 Mom & Dad
 ☒ 🎉 Fun

☒ 🚗 Toy Story
 ☒ 🍲 Food
 ☒ ☀️ My day

☒ 📍 Places
 ☒ ? Questions
 ☒ 📦 Things

Status

✓ Ready to use with no internet (pictures and voice saved on this device).

Version 76ab8aef26d1 · last checked Sep 24, 1:44 PM

[Check for updates now](#)

Tip: on the tablet, open this page in Chrome, then menu : → **Add to Home screen** (or **Install app**). It opens full screen like an app and keeps working with no internet.

Pictures: [Fluent Emoji](#) © Microsoft, MIT licence. Voices: [Kokoro](#), Apache 2.0.

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Done

D Pages to show. Untick a page to hide it on this tablet; tick it to bring it back. At least one page always stays on.

E Status. "✓ Ready to use with no internet" means everything is saved. Below it you'll see the version and when it last checked for updates.

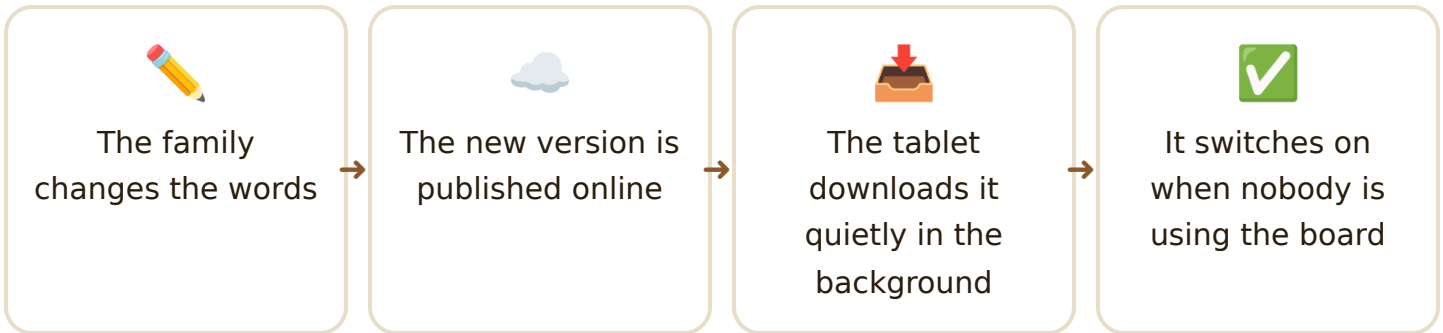
F Check for updates now. Gets the newest version straight away (see section 8).

G About & credits. Who made Talanoa and how to contact Faleofaz.

Tap **Done** at the bottom to close Settings.

8 Updates

You don't have to do anything. New words and fixes arrive by themselves.



- The tablet checks when Talanoa opens, when the screen turns back on, and every 30 minutes.
- It **never changes while someone is tapping**. It waits until nobody has tapped for 2 minutes, or the screen is off, and then comes back on the same page.
- **To update right now:** hold ⚙️ → **Check for updates now**. If there's something new, the app restarts by itself with it.

The message says...	Meaning
✓ You have the latest version.	Nothing to do.
Downloading the new version... the app will restart by itself.	Wait a few seconds.
A new version is ready and will switch on when the board is not in use.	It will update on its own soon.
Could not check: no internet connection right now.	Connect to Wi-Fi and try again. The board still works normally.

9 Without Wi-Fi

Once a tablet shows ✓ **Ready to use with no internet**, Talanoa works anywhere: on outings, in the car, or when the Wi-Fi is down. Pictures, words and the chosen voice are all saved on the tablet.

After choosing a new voice

Keep the tablet on Wi-Fi for a minute so the new voice can be saved. Until then, any sentence that isn't saved yet uses the tablet's own voice. It's never silent.

10 Tips for helping residents

A talking board works best when the people around it use it too.



Show, don't test

While you talk, tap the pictures yourself ("Let's have *lunch*", tapping Lunch). This is how people learn where things are. Never quiz them.



Give time

Wait after asking a question. Finding the right picture can take a while.



Every tap counts

Answer what was said, even if you think it was an accident. That's how they learn their words have power.



Keep it close and charged

The board only helps if it's within reach, all day, in every room.



Tell the family

Let the family know which pictures get used, and which words are missing.

Talanoa supports, it doesn't replace

Talanoa is a simple, friendly board, not a full professional speech system. A speech-language pathologist can suggest what each resident needs.

11 If something goes wrong

What you notice	What to do
No sound at all	Turn the tablet volume up with its side buttons. Check the tablet isn't on silent. In Settings, check Volume isn't low.
The voice sounds robotic	In Settings, Tablet voice is probably chosen. Choose Michael (or another named voice).
Only a brown bar, no pictures	It was opened in a preview (from email or Google Drive). Open Talanoa from its home-screen icon, or in Chrome.
A page is missing	Settings → Pages to show → tick it.
Settings won't open	Press and hold the ⚙ for a full second. A quick tap does nothing, on purpose.
New words from the family aren't showing	Connect to Wi-Fi, then Settings → Check for updates now .
"404 / There isn't a GitHub Pages site here"	The address was typed wrong. Use the QR code, or type tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa with a capital T.
The ► arrow jumped back to "I want"	That's normal: after the last page it starts again at the first.
The screen keeps turning off	See "Screen timeout" in section 12.
Something else looks wrong	Close Talanoa completely and open it again from its icon. If it still happens, take a photo of the screen and email it to Tim Broussard at tcdeveloper@gmail.com .

12 Looking after the tablet



Charge every night

A flat tablet means a resident with no voice.



Volume

Use the side buttons while Talanoa is talking to set how loud it is.



Screen timeout

On most Android tablets:

Settings → Display → Screen timeout, and choose a longer time (for example 10 minutes).



Clean and protect

Wipe the screen with a slightly damp cloth. A sturdy case is a good idea.

13 Asking for changes

New words, different wording, a real photo of someone instead of a picture: the family can add these. Write down what's needed (for example *"add Swing, 'I want to go on the swing'"*) and pass it to **Tim Broussard**. The change reaches every tablet automatically, usually the same day.

Tim Broussard

 tcdeveloper@gmail.com

14 Credits & contact

Talanoa was made with love by:

Tim Broussard

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Brenton Broussard

Legion

Faleofaz

Faleofaz

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Pictures: Fluent Emoji © Microsoft (MIT licence). Voices recorded with Kokoro, an open-source speech model (Apache 2.0).

Talanoa Staff Guide · <https://tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa/manual/>